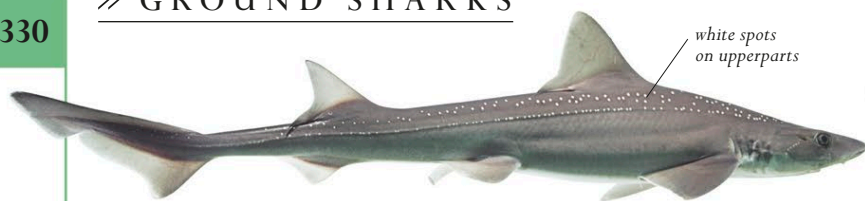


» GROUND SHARKS

**STARRY SMOOTH-HOUND***Mustelus asterias*

F: Triakidae

This small, common shark of the N.E. Atlantic has shiny skin and flat, slab-like teeth, ideal for crushing crabs and shellfish.

1.4 m
4½ ft1 m
3¼ ft**SMALL-SPOTTED CATSHARK***Scyliorhinus canicula*

F: Scyliorhinidae

Common in the N.E. Atlantic, this small shark is one of more than 100 similar species in its family. Its egg cases are called mermaid's purses.

larger dorsal
portion of tail4 m
13 ft

hammer-shaped head

SMOOTH HAMMERHEAD*Sphyrna zygaena*

F: Sphyrnidae

With its eyes at both ends of a T-shaped head, this shark has all-round vision. It is found worldwide in warm water.

MACKEREL SHARKS

The 16 species of shark in this order are large with a cylindrical body and conical head. The Lamniformes are (mostly) fearsome hunters and many of them can maintain a high body temperature, allowing them to sustain speed in cold waters.

3.9 m
13 ft**GOBLIN SHARK***Mitsukurina owstoni*

F: Mitsukurinidae

This shark has jaws that shoot forward to grab its prey. Living in the dark depths of the Atlantic, Pacific, and W. Indian oceans, it detects prey using its flat, electro-sensitive, bill-like snout.

3.2 m
10 ft**SAND TIGER SHARK***Carcharias taurus*

F: Odontaspidae

The menacing, dagger-like teeth of this large warm-water shark belie its docile nature. It is often kept in large public aquariums.

5.5 m
18 ft**MEGAMOUTH SHARK***Megachasma pelagios*

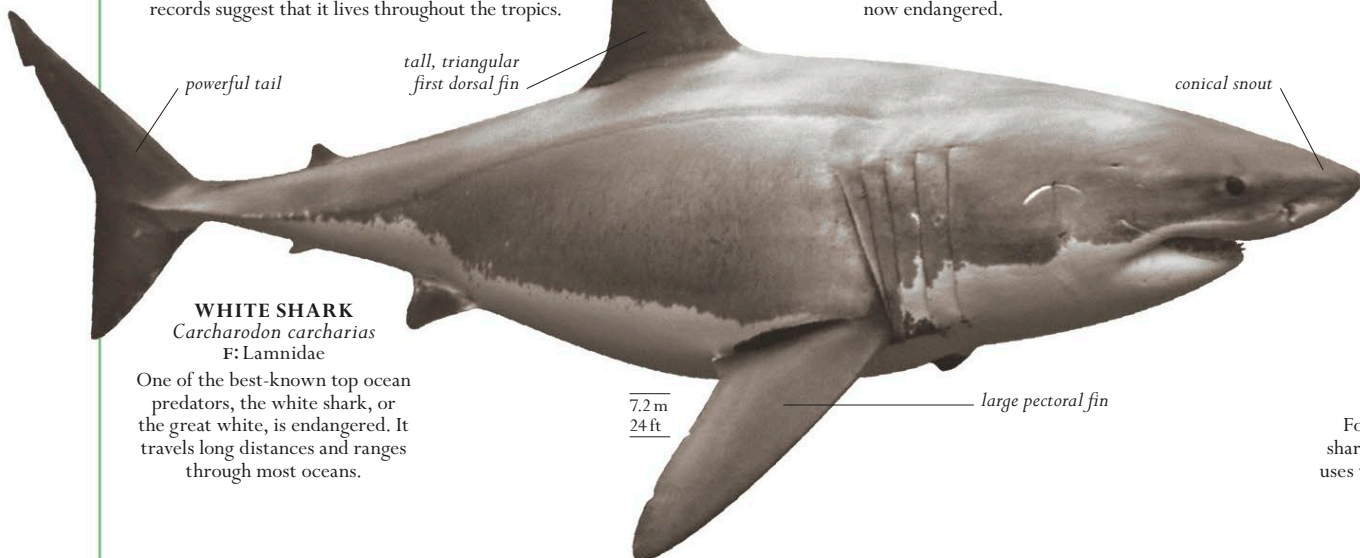
F: Megachasmidae

Undiscovered until 1976, this giant shark is a filter feeder. It sucks in plankton-rich water and strains out tiny shrimps and other plankton. The 100 or so records suggest that it lives throughout the tropics.

SHORTFIN MAKO*Isurus oxyrinchus*

F: Lamnidae

Capable of reaching 50 kph (31 mph), this may be the fastest of all sharks. Its range is worldwide except for polar waters, but it is now endangered.

4 m
13 ftpointed
snout

powerful tail

tall, triangular
first dorsal fin

conical snout

WHITE SHARK*Carcharodon carcharias*

F: Lamnidae

One of the best-known top ocean predators, the white shark, or the great white, is endangered. It travels long distances and ranges through most oceans.

7.2 m
24 ft

large pectoral fin

5.5 m
18 ft**THRESHER SHARK***Alopias vulpinus*

F: Alopiidae

Found almost worldwide, the thresher shark has a tail as long as its body, which it uses to lash into fish shoals and stun its prey.